

ADGM Strategic Priorities 2026

Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM) sets out its strategic priorities for 2026, focused on consolidating its position as a leading international financial centre in the MENA region. This document summarises the priority pillars, target outcomes, and associated risks for leadership review.

1. Strategic Priority Pillars

- Digital Assets & Tokenisation: expand the regulated digital asset framework and attract licensed virtual asset service providers.
- Sustainable Finance: grow green and transition-finance assets under administration and launch a regional climate disclosure standard.
- Capital Markets Deepening: increase listings, private credit funds, and family-office assets domiciled in ADGM.
- Talent & Skills: build a fintech and compliance talent pipeline through partnerships with universities and global firms.
- Regulatory Excellence: maintain principles-based, internationally aligned regulation to preserve investor confidence.

2. Target Outcomes for 2026

- Increase the number of registered entities by 30% year over year.
- Reach USD 150 billion in assets under management across funds domiciled in ADGM.
- License at least 25 new digital asset and fintech firms.
- Double sustainable-finance assets under administration versus 2024 baseline.

3. Digital Assets Focus

ADGM was an early mover in regulating digital assets and intends to extend this lead. Priorities include tokenisation of real-world assets, a clear stablecoin framework, and custody standards aligned with international best practice. Demand is driven by institutional interest in tokenised funds and regional sovereign wealth allocation to digital infrastructure.

4. Key Risks

- Regulatory arbitrage and competition from DIFC, Singapore, and emerging hubs.
- Global macro volatility reducing fund inflows.
- Talent shortage in specialised compliance and blockchain engineering roles.
- Reputational risk if digital asset firms fail without adequate consumer safeguards.

5. Recommended Leadership Actions

- Accelerate the tokenisation regulatory sandbox and publish guidance by Q2 2026.
- Establish a dedicated talent fund and regional fintech academy.
- Strengthen cross-border MoUs with comparable financial centres.